

PAD 114

QUESTION: TO Community DEVELOPMENT Topic: Principles of Felt-need.

Felt need are changes deemed necessary by people to correct the deficiencies they perceive in their community. The use of felt-need in community development practice involves the process of identifying needs, ranking their importances, and building programs based on the ranking.

The principles of felt-needs stresses that people must be able to identify what they want to do in order to achieve their desired development, such identification is possible when people are willing to remove obstacle to development.

Felt-need is one of the key concept in community development that identifies what people perceive and consider important to addressing in order to improve their community.

Felt need is a gap that an individual or group experiences that an individual or which motivates them to seek a solution or satisfaction.

Key principles

The following are the key principles of felt need:-

- (1) Subjective Experience:- Felt needs are subjective and Personal, Varying from Person to Person, What one Person considers a need, another might not.
- (2) Perceived Deficiency:- Felt needs arise from a perceived lack or deficiency, which can be physical, emotional, social, or Psychological.
- (3) Motivation:- Felt needs motivate individuals to take action, seek solutions, or make changes to address the perceived deficiency.
- (4) Hierarchy of needs:- Felt needs can be categorized into different levels, such as basic needs (e.g.

Food, shelter and clothing) Psychological needs (e.g. belonging, esteem) and Self-actualisation needs (e.g. personal growth, creativity).

(5) Influence of Culture and Environment:- felt need are shaped by cultural, social and environmental factors, which can influence what individuals perceive as needs and how they prioritize them.

How the principles of felt need work

- (1) Identify the needs of the community.
- (2) Rank the needs by importance
- (3) Use the ranking to build programs.

Topic 2 Principles of Democracy and Community Work

Democracy:- Is the government of the people, for the people and by the people.

The principles of democracy serve as a foundation for democratic community work, promoting social justice, equality, and collective decision-making.

The following are the principles of democracy and community work:-

- (1) Participation:- Encouraging all community members to participate in decision-making processes.
- (2) Inclusivity:- Ensuring equal opportunities for everyone to contribute, regardless of their background, race, gender, or socio-economic status.
- (3) Transparency:- Maintaining openness in all decision-making processes and actions.
- (4) Accountability:- Ensuring community members take responsibility for their actions and decisions.
- (5) Empowerment:- Building the capacity of community members to make informed decisions and take control of their lives.

6) Equality:- Promoting fairness and justice in the distribution of resources and opportunities.

7) Respect for minority rights:- protecting the rights and interests of minority groups within the community.

8) Rule of law:- Ensuring all community members adhere to agreed-upon rules and regulations.

Topic

Types Limitation of Government in providing the needs for the people.

The governments face several limitations in providing for the needs of their citizens.

Here are some of the key limitations:-

(1) Financial Constraints:- Governments have limited financial resources, which restricts their ability to provide for all needs of their citizens. They must prioritize spending and allocate resources efficiently.

(2) Bureaucratic inefficiencies:- Government bureaucracies can be slow to respond to changing needs and circumstances. Corruption can also hinder the effective delivery of services.

(3) Limited Reach and Accessibility:- Governments may struggle to reach remote or marginalized communities, making it difficult to provide services and support to those who need it most.

(4) Dependence of external factors:- Governments are often dependent on external factors such as global economic trends, natural disasters, and geopolitical events, which can impact their ability to provide for their citizens.

(5) Balancing Competing Demands:- Governments must balance competing demands and priorities such as funding for health care, education, infrastructure, and national defense.

6) Limited Expertise and capacity:- Governments may not have the necessary expertise or capacity to address complex issues such as climate change, cyber security threats, or pandemics.

7) Corruption and mismanagement:- Corruption and mismanagement can divert resources away from essential services and undermine the government's ability to provide for its citizens.

8) Regulatory Limitation:- Governments may be limited in their ability to regulate certain industries or activities, which can impact their ability to protect citizens' interests.

9) Public Expectations and Trust:- Governments must manage public expectations and maintain ~~public~~ trust. If citizens lose trust in their government, it can become increasingly difficult for the government to provide for their needs.

10) Constitutional and legal limitation:- Governments are bound by constitutional and legal frameworks that limit their power and authority. These limitations can restrict their power and authority. These limitations can restrict their ability to provide for certain needs of services.

Interpersonal relationship
In community development, interpersonal relationships refer to the social connections and interactions between individuals, which are crucial for building trust, fostering cooperation, and facilitating collective action towards shared goals.

Interpersonal relationships encompass the connections, interaction and bonds between two or more people within a community, they are ongoing interactions between people that involve the mutual fulfillment of both parties' needs.

Benefits Gain From Personal Group.

Personal group refers to a small, informal group of people who share similar interests, goals or characteristics and interact with each other on a personal level. These groups are often formed naturally and can play a significant role in community development.

Being part of a personal group can bring numerous benefits:-

(1) Social Benefits:-

(a) Support Network:- A personal group provides a support system where members can share their experience receive emotional support, and help each other through challenging times.

(b) Social Connections:- Being part of a group helps expand your social circle, making it easier to form new friendship and connections.

(c) Sense of Belonging:- Feeling part of a group can give you a sense of belonging, which is essential for emotional well-being.

(2) Personal Growth Benefits

(a) Learning and Development:- A personal group can facilitate learning and personal growth through shared experiences, workshops, or training sessions.

(b) Accountability:- Being part of a group can help you stay accountable and motivated to achieve your goals.

(c) Diverse Perspectives:- Interacting with people from different backgrounds and experiences can broaden your perspective, helping you become more empathetic and open minded.

(3) Practical Benefit

(a) Shared Resources:- Group members can share resources such as knowledge, expertise, or equipment, making it easier to achieve common goals.

(5) Collaboration:- Working together on projects or initiatives can foster innovation, creativity and problem solving.

(6) Networking Opportunities:- Being part of a group can provide opportunities to connect with people from various industries or professions, potentially leading to new career opportunities.

(4) Emotional Benefits

(a) Stress Relief:- Sharing experiences and emotions with group members can help reduce stress and anxiety.

(b) Increase Confidence:- Receiving support and encouragement from group members can boost self-confidence and self-esteem.

(c) Improve Mental Health:- Being part of a supportive group can contribute to improved mental health and well-being.

Achievement that could lead to embarking on more projects in community development.

The followings are some of the achievements that could lead to embarking on more projects in community development:-

(1) Successful Project Completion:- Completing a community development project on time, within budget and to the beneficiaries.

(2) Community Engagement:- Fostering strong relationships with community members, leaders and organizations, ensuring their active participation and ownership in the project.

(3) Capacity Building:- Developing the skills and capacities of community members, local organizations, and project staff to sustain and scale up community development initiatives.

(4) Sustainability: Ensuring the long term sustainability of community development projects through effective planning, resource mobilization, and community ownership.

(5) Monitoring and Evaluation: Establishing robust monitoring and evaluation systems to track progress, assess impact and inform future project design and implementation.

(6) Innovative solution: Introducing innovative solutions, technologies, or approaches that address specific challenges and needs.

(7) Recognition and Awards: Receiving recognition or Awards for outstanding community development work, demonstrating excellence and commitment to improving community well-being.

(8) Partnerships and Collaborations: Establishing Partnerships with local government, NGOs, businesses and other stake holders to leverage resources, expertise and funding.

Topic 2: Community Development Worker

Community development worker are professionals who work with communities to identify their needs, develop solutions, and implement projects that promote social, economic and environmental development. Examples of community development workers are youth workers, health educators, community organizers and housing counselors.

According to Anyanwu (1999) Community development Worker is a multi-purpose worker or a generator of the change process. Thus, it is for this reason he is often referred to as seen as "change agent".

Roh (2000) perceived community development workers as a person who is always on the move to achieve a goal - setting the organisations' sensitivities

utilises and coordinates the efforts of the people into developing their environment.

Roles of Community Development Worker

- (1) His role as a guide,
- (2) His role as a social physical therapist

Role As a Guide

The principal role of a professional CDW is that of a guide who helps the community to establish and find means of achieving its own goals. Eze (2001) affirmed that his role as a guide helps the community not only to establish goals but also in reaching goals already established. empowering community to identify their needs and mobilise resource

As a Guide, a community development worker

facilitates community empowerment by helping residents identify needs, resources and solutions, empowering them to take ownership of their development and achieve their goals.

The following are the roles of the community development worker as a guide:-

- (1) Facilitating community need assessments:- CDW guide communities in identifying their needs, challenges, and aspiration through various methods like surveys, focus groups and community meeting.
- (2) Providing information and resources:- They act as a bridge, connecting community members with relevant information, resource, and services, ensuring they have the tools to address their issues.

- (3) Empowering Community Participation:- CDW foster active participation by encouraging community members to be involved in decision making processes, planning and implementation of projects.

4) Promoting Collaboration and Partnership:- They work to build strong relationship and partnerships with various stakeholders, including local organizations, government agencies, and community leaders to achieve common goals.

(5) Advocating for Community Needs:- As a guide, they represent the voices and needs of the community to policymakers and other decision-makers, advocating for policies and programs that address community priorities.

Role As a Social Physical / Therapist

Community Development worker plays his role as a Social Physical / Therapist. This implies diagnosis and treatment of the community as a whole. To do this, the CDW must know the origin and history of the community as a whole and in its separate parts and entity.

As a CDW social physical therapist can bridge the gap between healthcare and community well-being promoting physical activity, accessible resources, and inclusive environments for all residents, particularly those with physical limitations.

His diagnosis should provide the community with some understanding of its nature the community in a process in which self-understanding releases tension and removes blocks to cooperative work.

The following are the roles of CDW as a social physical therapist:-

(1) Community Needs Assessment:- Conduct thorough assessments to identify physical activity barriers, health disparities and accessibility challenges within the community.

- (2) Program Development and Implementation:-
 - Design and implement evidence-based physical activity programs, rehabilitation, initiative and accessibility improvements to the specific needs of the community.
- (3) Education and Awareness:- Educate community members about the benefits of physical activity, healthy lifestyles, and available resources, promoting positive health behaviours.
- (4) Empowerment and Inclusion:- Foster a sense of empowerment and inclusion by creating opportunities for people of all abilities to participate in physical activity and community life.
- (5) Monitoring and Evaluation:- Continuously monitor the effectiveness of programs and interventions, making adjustments as needed to ensure positive outcomes and promote sustainability.

Skills of Community Development Worker

- Professional Community Worker is to possess some skills in order to perform his task effectively.
- The skills of CDW will be assess or treated with particular reference to the following:-
 - (1) Surveying:- This is a process of preliminary fact-finding investigation, it gives the CDW an opportunity to get first-hand information about a particular community. The information collected through Surveying should be used for diagnosis covering as many aspects of community life as possible.
 - Surveying could be viewed as an investigation of the opinion, behaviour of a particular group of people or community which is usually done by asking them questions the essence of surveying is to avoid mistake and waste of resource.

(2) Planning. Koontz and others (1996) put it as deciding in advance what to do, how to do it, when to do it and who will do it. In essence planning bridges the gap from where we are, to where we want to go and it involves the setting of goals and objectives and their implementation. CW requires planning skill to be able to coordinate people, organise scarce resource for maximum utilization and realisation of goals. Thus planning is the most vital step in any major development actions.

(3) Directing. This involves effective leadership and guidance at all times to ensure that the decisions are taken in the community. The CW ensure unity of direction, All members of the community must work together to accomplish common objectives.

The CW should provide that leadership as advocated by Fayol that "directing of activities should be done by the administrative head to avoid delays, confusion, indiscipline" thus he requires traits such as modesty, friendliness, frankness, fairness and impartiality etc.

(4) Organizing. This is the specification of how the resources both human and materials available to be carried are allocate and arranged in order to achieve productivity as well as meet the set standard of the community.

(5) Spatial Organization. Spatial is referring to or relating to space, position, size and shape of things. Here, it has to do with how CW poses the ability to organized activities that are scattered in the rural villages, in other to achieved inter-

objectives. in other words, it is the ability of CDW to organises various households, associations clubs etc with different size, composition and the position they occupy in issues regarding community development.

Qualities of the Community Development worker

A CDW has to posses some distinct qualities that will qualify him/her in the process of carrying out the responsibilities required for the growth and development of the community. these qualities would be discuss by making reference to the following:-

(1) Agreement to People's beliefs:- This is the ability of the CDW to work with different kinds of people in the community whose beliefs or religion is contrary to that of the CDW. He/she has to build mechanism of tolerance in order to carryout the tasks required of him/her. the origin, history and beliefs of the community as a whole must be known by the CDW in order to secure support and cooperation from the community.

(2) Moral force:- Moral force were connect character, the CDW has to posses. that is to be of good character or led others by example. He has to keep right in carrying out his duty and character wise.

(3) Respect:- Respect is the first stepping stone in building a relationship between group of individuals in the community. therefore, as a CDW He/she have to respect the ways of life of people in the community, the religion, culture, values and norms of the community has to be respected by the CDW in order to attract acceptance and

Cooperation from the community.

(4) Courtesy- The word courtesy simple means an act of showing willness or generosity in providing something that is needed by the people free of charge.

CNW have to practice a habit of given out his resources freely for the growth and development of the community when the need arises. That is the making an history to leave other better than you found them.

Courtesy could also means polite behaviour that show respect for others people.